Author Biographies

Stay, React, or Conform? Examining Social Influence Effects on Aesthetic Judgments

Omar Lizardo

Omar Lizardo (He/Him) is the LeRoy Neiman Term Chair Professor in the Department of Sociology at the University of California, Los Angeles. He studies Culture, Cognition, Networks, Consumption, Institutions, Organization, and Social Theory. His work has appeared in such journals as *American Sociological Review*, *Social Forces*, *Sociological Forum*, *Sociological Theory*, *Journal for the Theory of Social Behavior*, *Poetics*, and *Social Networks*. He is the co-editor of the *Handbook of Classical Sociological Theory*, published by Springer, and co-author of the books *Measuring Culture*, published by Columbia University Press, and *Orienting to Chance*, published by the University of Chicago Press. He is currently one of the co-editors of the journal *Sociological Theory*, a member of the Board of Reviewing Editors for the journal *Science*, an Associate Editor for the journal *Theory & Social Inquiry*, the current chair of the ASA's section on Mathematical Sociology, and a former chair of the ASA's Section on the Sociology of Culture. His recent publications have focused on developing a theory of the microfoundations of institutions, conceptualizing diversity as a dominant social value, tracing the spread of "categorical tolerance" in musical tastes, and developing techniques for analyzing two-mode network data.

Sara Skiles

Sara Skiles (She/Her) holds a Ph.D. in Sociology from the University of Notre Dame, where her dissertation examined the use of aesthetic taste expression as a technique of social boundary drawing. Her research interests include cultural capital, aesthetic taste, and network formation. She previously worked as a researcher in the Centre for the Study of Religion and Society in the Department of Sociology at the University of Notre Dame, serving as project manager for the Cardus Religious Schools Initiative and managing the fourth wave of data collection for the National Study of Youth and Religion. She is currently the Associate Director of Finance at the University of Notre Dame's DeBartolo Performing Arts Center, where she is responsible for the center's financial stewardship and business operations, including fund flow monitoring and contracting with artists and campus partners.